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Stakeholder Interview Transcript

Enterprise: Mentoring Division — Center for Student Affairs (CSA), University of Asia and the Pacific (UA&P)

Project: Enterprise Architecture Conceptual Solution (Academic Case Study)

Interviewees:

- Ms. Nina (Staff / Operations Coordinator, Mentoring Division, CSA)
- Ms. Kellai (Staff / Operations Coordinator, Mentoring Division, CSA)

Interviewers / Student Architects:

- Emmanuel Velasco (Student 1 - Lead Interviewer)
 - DeeJay Clark Datu (Student 2 - Co-Interviewer / Technical Notes)
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Verbatim Interview Transcript

[00:00] Student 1: ...for this subject is to create a conceptual enterprise architecture solution for a client. And in this case, we are asking for your request if we could work with you. So that project, that solution will cover or aims to improve a possible problem that you may have or any projects that you wish to have it implemented. So we will be basically prescribing a set of steps or and a possible system that could be developed in...

[00:35] Ms. Nina: Okay. So more on, we're going to share with you what our current challenges are, and then you're going to check what are the possible solutions that you can suggest?

[00:48] Student 1: Yes. Not just... we will be needing not just the problems, pati rin 'yung mga (also the) business processes and business structures that the Mentoring Department has.

[00:59] Ms. Nina: Okay.

[01:00] Ms. Kellai: Tama ba ako (Am I right), you will be working with us up until December, 'no (right)?

[01:06] Student 1: Yes po (Yes, ma'am). But...

[01:08] Student 2: More or less.

[01:09] Student 1: Yes, but just to mind that we're still in the first phases pa lang, 'yung (only, the) approval phase. So depending on the input of our instructor, baka (maybe) this project proposal working with you might not be approved.

[01:25] Ms. Nina: Might not be approved. And then if it will be approved, what would be the... what would be the outcome? It will be create...

[01:34] Student 1: Basically a document... most likely will be a document detailing a proposed solution for your problem or project.

[01:45] Student 2: Actually, majority of our deliverables, from what we've been told, are puro (purely) documents lang (only).

[01:51] Ms. Nina: All right. Okay.

[01:56] Student 1: Yeah. All right. Ah, it's recording? All right. So, may we begin the interview?

[02:03] Ms. Nina: Sure.

[02:04] Student 1: So, first po (sir/ma'am)... can you briefly describe each of your roles in the Mentoring Department?

[02:16] Ms. Nina: Ah, sige (Ah, okay). All right. The thing is, we... I actually transferred recently to the Mentoring Department. I used to be with another unit within CSA. But the main role of the mentoring unit is to ensure that all students undergo mentoring. Okay? They're paired with a mentor and a mentee... ay sorry (oh sorry), with a mentor. So all the mentees are paired with a mentor. Okay? Um, so this year, there's a new policy—I'm not sure if you guys are aware of it—so there's a new policy wherein all students are required to undergo... uh, to have three mentoring sessions per semester. Okay? So because of that new policy, we hope that the mentoring frequency happening within the university will increase. Okay? So our role is to ensure all students are paired with mentors. Okay? So students are paired with mentors... It's the schools who actually, what do you call this, who are the first people who pair the students with their mentors. But we make sure that there is good distribution between the students and the mentors. Okay? There is an approved list of mentors. Okay? So the students are just assigned to those approved mentors. Okay? So my role right now is to ensure that we have a database, okay, that we know who the students are paired with. Let me know if it's too ano ha (too what, okay), fast, right? And then I, Miss Kelai and I will be the ones to monitor if the students, all students, are able to meet the three required sessions per semester.

[04:53] Ms. Nina: So the mechanism that we're using in monitoring the sessions is that the students would log the sessions using a Google Form, okay, with the details of the session included

in what they will input. And then an email will be sent to the mentor to confirm the details of the session or request for a correction.

[05:30] Ms. Kelai: Have you had your mentoring session?

[05:34] Student 1: Uh, I... I already had mine started earlier.

[05:36] Ms. Kelai: Ah, so you have... you've seen the...

[05:38] Student 1: I haven't did the forms yet. I did the mentoring during like the second week of classes.

[05:43] Ms. Kelai: Since you are working with us, try the form ha (okay)?

[05:46] Student 1: Yes po (Yes, ma'am).

[05:48] Ms. Nina: So part of our task is to make sure that all students know about the form, okay? All the students know about the process in logging of sessions, and monitoring that all students meet the requirement, the three sessions per semester. Okay?

[06:12] Student 1: Uh, roughly how many mentors are there?

[06:15] Ms. Nina: Around...

[06:18] Ms. Kelai: 180... 120...

[06:23] Ms. Nina: Release... So... 180. Roughly around 180.

[06:28] Student 1: 180.

[06:29] Student 2: 180. And then how many students are paired with a mentor?

[06:34] Ms. Nina: Okay, the students...

[06:36] Student 2: How many per mentor?

[06:38] Ms. Nina: Depends on the mentor.

[06:39] Student 2: Depends on the mentor?

[06:40] Ms. Nina: Yes. We also have professional mentors... uh, the... not exactly professional mentors, but external mentors, those who are not faculty members or staff of the school, but are associated with the university. Okay? So they are professionals who can guide the students in their academic journey. Okay? But most of the mentors are employees of the university.

[07:14] Student 1: Okay. So how does the Mentoring Department fit within the larger CSA, and who do you guys report to?

[07:29] Ms. Nina: Okay. For the large... Well, it used to be in tandem with the Office of Guidance and Counseling, eh (you see). It used to be Office of Guidance and Counseling and Mentoring. OGCM, 'di ba (right), Miss Kelai? And then they separated the two, they divided the two units. So, because aside from... The Counseling focuses on the mental health of the students. Okay? Whereas the Mentoring is not only focused... it's on the holistic formation of the students. Holistic.

So that's our role in CSA. It's actually... well, UA&P is actually one of the few schools that has mentoring in their services. You can indicate that... you can include that. So we report directly to our Executive Director. Okay? Her name is Ms. Maria Concha De La Cruz.

[08:53] Student 2: Ms. Maria...

[08:54] Ms. Nina: Concha.

[08:55] Student 2: Spelling?

[08:56] Ms. Nina: C-O-N-C-H-A.

[09:02] Student 2: Okay. De La Cruz.

[09:08] Student 1: 'Yung as (Regarding as) Ms. Maria De La Cruz, what duties and responsibilities does she have with regards to the Mentoring Department?

[09:18] Ms. Nina: Ah, she's the one reporting to the ManCom (Management Committee) about updates on mentoring. Okay? She, as the chair of the Operations Committee of the CSA, she's the one who coordinates with the different school OpComs (Operations Committees) about mentoring concerns.

[09:55] Student 1: Besides yourselves, who else is directly involved in running the mentoring program? Ah, mentoring program, sorry.

[10:02] Ms. Nina: From CSA or other...?

[10:04] Student 1: Within the CSA and Mentoring Department, that is.

[10:07] Ms. Nina: Okay. Within CSA, it's just the two of us. Yes. Okay. But with the other schools, we coordinate with the school Operations Committee, respective Operations Committee, and the mentoring... school mentoring coordinators.

[10:33] Ms. Kelai: In addition to Miss... Miss Nina, we also coordinate with HR regarding the external mentors' contracts. We also directly coordinate with FMR (Financial Management and Resources) for the... again, the external mentors' allowances. Before, we have mentoring portal parang (like a) point person. But now, we coordinate with ICT... ay (or), IT Office. Because before, we have a portal, Mentoring Portal. But now, because of the new form, and the new policy, and the new procedure on how to log in mentoring sessions, we are now coordinating with the IT officers... IT Office.

[11:44] Student 1: Okay. If a new tool or process change were introduced, who would need to approve it?

[11:50] Ms. Nina: Aha! Well, first it would have to be approved at the level of Miss Concha. Okay? And then... well, Miss Concha, and then to an extent, since it's an institutional policy, mentoring is

an institutional... the mentoring program is under an institutional policy, we might have to request for the approval of ManCom (Management Committee). If it's going to be a drastic change. Okay?

[12:35] Student 1: Does the program run the same way across all the other colleges and departments, or does it vary by unit?

[12:44] Ms. Nina: It's ano (what)... it's, what do you call this, it is one. It's just one program across all the schools. Okay? But it covers the JC (Junior College) and undergraduate students, including the 5YP (Five-Year Program) and 6YP (Six-Year Program) students. Okay? But for the GPO, that's the graduate program standalone programs, they are encouraged to undergo mentoring, to participate, but it's not required for them.

[13:27] Ms. Kelai: But we still do pair them.

[13:31] Student 1: Ah, so the graduates are the ones mentoring the students, or...?

[13:36] Ms. Nina: No, no, no. Our graduate students, those who are, say for example, taking up MA Educational Leadership, MScM evening program, those... the ones that are, what do you call this, already working, okay, they are also paired with a mentor, but it's not required from them to participate in mentoring. Okay? Unlike with the undergraduate students, you are required to have three sessions per semester.

[14:14] Ms. Kelai: Also we have different... EM (Executive Masters / Evening Masters) has their own policy as well. In the EM mentoring program, they have their own policy as well. But some of the EM students, they avail the mentoring... the regular mentoring program.

[14:38] Ms. Nina: I think they are going to follow the policy... So it's okay. I think they're going to follow the same policy.

[14:57] Student 1: How does the mentee-mentor matching process work?

[15:05] Ms. Nina: Okay. So we provide the schools with the list of approved mentors, okay? And usually, they pair the students with the faculty members or staff that are under their school. So it means to say that there is a level of familiarity with the people, okay, that they're going to pair with the students. Okay? And then, say for example, if you're IT, there are several IT professors who might be paired with you guys, who are likely to be paired with you guys. Okay?

[15:53] Student 1: But in my case, I wasn't paired with an IT professor.

[15:57] Ms. Nina: Yes, so it depends on the availability and the capacity of the approved mentors during the pairing process. Okay? There is also, there are also cases wherein they're paired during their JC, Junior College, and then since there is a good mentoring relationship between the mentor and the mentee, the pairing has been retained. Okay? Until they finish their schooling.

[16:32] Student 1: I know there's cases naman (on the other hand) that a mentee might request a mentor change. What are usually the reasons for this?

[16:40] Ms. Nina: Well, in the past, what we've heard is that there might not be a connection, okay? There might not be a rapport, or they might have encountered somebody else within the university whom they think can guide them better.

[17:08] Ms. Kelai: Another reason is, some of the mentors, they already resigned.

[17:19] Student 1: What about in the cases that the student has not met with their mentor, but suddenly they were given a new mentor? I have a friend of mine, he had not met with his mentor yet, but then around our third year, may bago siyang (he got a new) mentor. Pero (However) his old mentor is the same mentor as mine, eh. So what would be the reason for that sudden change?

[17:48] Ms. Nina: If there was not a relationship that was established, that might be... that might have prompted the school to reassign another mentor. Okay? Say for example, for that friend of yours, maybe the mentor that was assigned to him has said that they were not able to meet or something, and perhaps that this student might be paired or assigned to another mentor and might be better in... There's also the case wherein the students are the ones requesting for the change of mentor. Okay?

[18:38] Student 2: To clarify lang (only), who does assign 'yung (the) mentor pairing?

[18:46] Ms. Nina: Schools.

[18:47] Student 2: Ah, 'yung schools mismo? So hindi kayo? (Ah, the schools themselves? So not you?) Okay.

[18:50] Ms. Nina: Because they know the students better, and they know the pool of mentors within their department better.

[19:05] Student 1: When recording the mentored sessions, this is using Google Forms plus an Excel sheet, 'di ba, tama po ba? (right, is that correct?)

[19:15] Ms. Nina: No, it's just a Google Form. Just a Google Form.

[19:19] Student 1: So what data specifically is used from the Google Form?

[19:25] Ms. Nina: We just need the date... just generic information: the date, the length of the session... the duration, if it's here in the university, where in the university it was conducted, just the purpose of the session. And just a short... we incorporated a short survey if the mentoring session was able to meet the goals that the student has set for that particular session. So it's just that. We don't ask for personal or confidential information, because whatever is discussed during the mentoring session is confidential, and we respect that.

[20:16] Student 1: With regards to like 'yung (the) last question regarding if the mentoring session met its goals, for what purposes is that?

[20:26] Ms. Nina: We're trying to find out if the mentoring session, from the perspective of both the mentor and the mentee, is effective, in that sense, you know? If it actually, what do you call this, if it actually meets its purpose.

[20:50] Student 1: Can you explain how the old process for recording mentoring sessions worked?

[20:56] Ms. Nina: I think it was the mentor... It was the mentor who logs the session.

[21:04] Student 1: How did they log it?

[21:06] Ms. Kelai: First, we have the portal for so many years. And then just last year, we also... we again introduced a new Google Form din (also).

[21:22] Student 1: By any chance, is the portal still running?

[21:27] Ms. Kelai: It can be viewed, but then hindi na siya gano'n ka... ka... ka-useful, oo, ka-useful than nung during those years na running siya. Kasi it can generate reports, it can generate the past history. For example, 1st sem of last two years... (it is no longer as... as... as useful, yes, as useful as during those years when it was running. Because it can generate reports, it can generate the past history. For example, 1st sem of last two years...)

[22:01] Student 1: Is it possible if we could access that, this portal, for the purpose of this project?

[22:07] Ms. Kelai: We still have to...

[22:09] Ms. Nina: We have to check. That's one. Two, Mr. Pira is your [instructor]...?

[22:14] Student 1: Yes po (Yes, ma'am).

[22:15] Ms. Nina: So he knows about the portal because he was the one who created it! (Laughter)

[22:20] Student 1: So we'll just ask him! (Laughter)

[22:21] Ms. Nina: Yes, you just ask him! Yeah, when I had some questions, he's the one I asked. So just ask him!

[22:28] Student 1: We'll ask him!

[22:30] Ms. Nina: Yes!

[22:34] Student 1: Would you say that the current process, 'yung G-Form, 'yung (the G-Form, the) Google Forms is better than the portal?

[22:40] Ms. Kelai: We still don't know, 'di ba? Kasi (right? Because) it's our first sem, first time to have the students logging in the session, the mentoring session.

[22:51] Student 1: What led to the decision to take down the portal and then replace it with Google Forms?

[22:56] Ms. Kelai: Probably because of, for example, I have 90 mentees. I have 90 students under me, so it's sometimes difficult for me to log all those 90 sessions. Sometimes I forgot to log them. But for you, isa lang ang mentor niyo, 'di ba? Na kumbaga you can take, have your time talaga to log the session. (you only have one mentor, right? Where in other words you can take, have your time really to log the session.)

[23:25] Student 1: So basically the responsibility of logging it is now on the students themselves, not the mentors?

[23:32] Ms. Kelai: Yes. Pero mayro'n pa rin, kasi iko-confirm... at least this time, iko-confirm din naman nila. (Yes. But there is still something, because it will be confirmed... at least this time, they will also confirm it.)

[23:41] Student 1: But less work on the mentors' side.

[23:44] Ms. Nina: And we also want the students to be more involved in this, because the policy applies to them, eh (you see). It doesn't actually apply to the mentor; the mentoring policy applies to the students. So we want them to... we want to ensure that they are involved. And of course, when they log their sessions, they can use it as proof (laughter) that they had the session itself, that they were able to do the session.

[24:18] Student 1: If a student did not meet the required number of mentoring sessions, is there a consequence?

[24:25] Ms. Nina: Yes. They will be placed on follow-up status. Okay? So it means to say that the Office of Student Mentoring will get in touch with them towards the end of the semester, informing them that they have not been able to meet the requirements, the required number of sessions. And we will try to schedule mentoring sessions for them, okay, so that they'll be able to comply. If they are on follow-up status for two consecutive semesters, it may affect their eligibility to enroll. Have you... Have you received the policy?

[25:27] Student 1: Yes, we did.

[25:29] Ms. Nina: Read the policy! It's there! (Laughter)

[25:33] Student 1: To be honest, I mostly skimmed it, but I got the general understanding of it. I have to reread it.

[25:39] Ms. Nina: Yes.

[25:53] Student 1: So what's the most frustrating or time-consuming part of managing the mentoring program right now?

[26:01] Ms. Nina: Right now, it's ensuring that our database is complete and that we have informed all students of their... of the details of their mentors.

[26:13] Ms. Kelai: Individual 'to, ha? (This is done individually, okay?)

[26:15] Ms. Nina: We're talking about almost 1,500, 1,600 students! So, right, and we're coordinating with several schools. So, you know... Yeah. (Laughter)

[26:31] Student 1: And this database, is it physical or digital?

[26:34] Ms. Nina: Digital.

[26:35] Student 1: Digital. What system?

[26:37] Ms. Nina: I'm using Google Sheets.

[26:38] Student 1: Google Sheets.

[26:41] Ms. Kelai: Plus 'di ba 'yung ginawa ni Miss Nina this sem, we also inform individually the mentors as well. Na so to... mayro'ng check-in tayo: "Hi mentor, this is the list of mentees that you have for this school year." So it's 1,500 plus... (Plus remember what Miss Nina did this sem, we also inform individually the mentors as well. Where in order to... we have a check-in: "Hi mentor, this is the list of mentees that you have for this school year." So it's 1,500 plus...)

[27:07] Ms. Nina: 180! Yeah! So right now, what we're prioritizing is to inform the students of their... what do you call this, of their mentors. Okay? The schools have more or less informed the mentors that they have... they are going to pair them. Kasi (Because), say for example, Mr. David is a mentor, but he has mentees across all schools. Okay? So those schools have gotten in touch with him and have asked him if he's willing to take on more mentees. Okay? So there might have been some communication done to give him an idea of who his mentees are from the different schools. On our part, what we will give the mentors is a summary of their mentees across all schools.

[28:07] Student 1: I just remembered, since you mentioned monitoring if the sessions... Regarding my friend, he actually met with our mentor already. So were there any instances where the change in mentor was a result of undocumented established relationships or established sessions before?

[28:34] Ms. Nina: There might have been. Okay? There might have been. That's why we are enforcing this kind of, in a way, required logging of the sessions. Okay? Because there have been instances in the past wherein there were informal mentorship discussions between the mentees and the mentors, and they were not logged by the mentors using the mentoring portal. Okay? So what we want to do now is to ensure that we have the appropriate data available to us. That's why we need... That's why we need the students to log their sessions! (Laughter)

[29:30] Ms. Kelai: And siguro (maybe) the best person to answer... this sem, ha (okay), kasi schools ngayon nag-pair (because schools are the ones who paired now), the best person to answer your inquiry is the school. Kasi sila 'yung nag-finalize ng pairing. Ang binigay lang sa amin is database. Kung may changes man, we just follow kung ano 'yung pinasa sa amin ng schools this year, this sem.

(Because they are the ones who finalized the pairing. What was given to us is just the database. If there are changes, we just follow whatever was passed to us by the schools this year, this sem.)

[29:59] Student 1: Is it possible if we could get, let's say, two contacts from any of the schools that we could try to get in touch with?

[30:06] Ms. Nina: Okay. In SSE, I'll give you SSE. Of course, that would be Dr. Olmos. For male. For female, it used to be Dr. Rodriguez, but I think she's on leave. Okay? So you can talk to Doc Loy. Another school that you might be able to talk to... Yes, Dr. Ladao. You know Dr. Ladao?

[30:40] Student 1: Yes, he's my mentor.

[30:42] Ms. Nina: Okay! So you can talk to Doc James extensively about this! (Laughter) He's the one pairing for the SED students.

[30:51] Ms. Kelai: Two schools lang (only)? Okay ka na ro'n? (Are you okay with that?)

[30:54] Student 1: Or do you want... Is that enough?

[31:04] Student 2: Question lang (only)... because a part of our deliverables, we need to diagram 'yung pag-flow ng data (the flow of data). I'm not sure, pero (but) I think we need then 'yung (the) what kind of data that you keep sa (in your) databases niyo, if that's allowed for you to share.

[31:27] Ms. Nina: Okay. What we have for the database is just the name of the student... well, student number, name of student, program, year level, email address of the student, and then the mentor. Just that. Just those things.

[31:48] Ms. Kelai: And siguro Miss, email din ng mentor? (And maybe Miss, mentor's email as well?)

[31:50] Ms. Nina: Oo, email address ng mentor. (Yes, mentor's email address.)

[31:53] Student 1: With regards to the year level, you have to manually change that? Let's say, first year, and then next year they're still there, second year, you have to manually change that in the database?

[32:05] Ms. Nina: Before, we have to check with the Registrar about the enrollment of the students, because there are students who have been paired with mentors but have not enrolled for this particular semester. So we need to remove them from the database as well. That's why we need to change it manually for the year level.

[32:30] Student 2: So is it just one big database or do you have multiple databases ba (question marker) for other purposes?

[32:37] Ms. Nina: Right now, we just have one database for pairings. What you just said gave me an idea: maybe we can integrate the, what do you call this, the session record form into that database, so that we will be able to see it. If you want to give me a solution on how to do that! (Laughter) Because for the database for the session logs, it's a Google Form, right? So they send an email to

the mentor asking them to confirm or to request for a correction regarding the details of the session. So if once the mentor has confirmed the session, the student will be notified, and then it will be reflected in the Google Sheet associated with the Google Form, right? But we also want to ensure that you can incorporate it to the master database that we have, the main database that we have, so that we can monitor how many sessions that particular student was able to have within the semester.

[34:10] Ms. Nina: I think it's doable.

[34:12] Student 1: It's doable. But we will still have to check what needs to be done. With regards to the mentor double checking if tama 'yung mga (correct are the) details, it's just an email?

[34:27] Ms. Nina: Yes. And then they just respond back to that email. It opens to another window. It uses Google Script, eh (you see).

[34:52] Ms. Kelai: Sana gumawa na lang ulit ng bagong portal! (Laughter) (I wish they just made a new portal again!)

[34:56] Ms. Nina: 'Yun pa nga kay Miss Kelai actually. (That's actually what Miss Kelai was saying.)

[35:00] Student 1: As per the requirements of our project, it's only the conceptual side. Although Sir Pira is actually recommending that we continue with the development phase after.

[35:14] Ms. Nina: Why not?

[35:15] Student 2: Pwede. (Possible.) (Laughter) I'm willing.

[35:20] Student 1: If feasible, also considering other requirements that we have to pass for next sem.

[35:27] Ms. Nina: So this is a sample, okay? So this is what the mentor will receive. This is just a sample, kaya gani-ganito lang (that's why it looks just like this). Okay. So what happens is that, if I click here "Confirm Details", so it will open to another... Yeah. So already reviewed na, ganyan (like that). Na-review ko na kasi na-approve na. (I already reviewed it because it was already approved.) So it just opens to another window, and then they will just click "Yes" or "No", just to confirm. And then it automatically updates itself in the Google Sheet for that form.

[36:12] Student 1: Who generates the email, specifically 'yung mga (the) details?

[36:17] Ms. Nina: What do you mean who generates?

[36:18] Student 1: Who creates this template?

[36:27] Ms. Nina: The IT Office. The IT Office created the template, but we were the ones who defined the details that will be required.

[36:39] Student 1: Okay, so if I understand correctly, the student answers the Google Forms, and where will that data be sent?

[36:47] Ms. Nina: The data will be sent to the mentor. The student will specify the mentor's email address. Okay? So the details will be sent to the mentor, and the mentor will just confirm or request for approval.

[37:04] Student 1: Let me clarify my question. So the student answers the form, the data would be recorded in the form's Google Sheet, and then there's a script that specifically formats the response to the mentor?

[37:18] Ms. Nina: Yes.

[37:20] Student 1: And then the mentor answers that, and then it will be recorded back into the sheet?

[37:23] Ms. Nina: Yes. And then we have a separate email wherein we can monitor who among the mentors were able to confirm.

[37:34] Student 1: Is that another script?

[37:37] Ms. Nina: I'm not sure! You have to ask the IT Office about it! (Laughter) I just know that they used a script. So that's why I mentioned it so that you guys would know. I can show you the a sample of the... He's always sending... A sample of the mentoring session review. So ayan (there), you can just have a look.

[38:10] Student 1: So again, just to repeat, I'm just trying to understand that. So when the mentor confirms the session on that script, the confirmation will be sent both to the forms Google Sheet and to another email?

[38:31] Ms. Nina: Yes.

[38:33] Student 1: And that email is its own dedicated... another separate email dedicated?

[38:37] Ms. Nina: An admin email. Just to...

[38:40] Student 1: Ayun (There), admin email.

[38:41] Ms. Nina: For us. So that we have a monitoring, kasi (because) if ever that there are questions or something...

[39:00] Student 1: You have access to the forms database, correct?

[39:05] Ms. Nina: Yes.

[39:24] Student 1: Can you clarify on why is the admin email necessary when you can already check the Google Forms sheet?

[39:35] Ms. Nina: The Google Form sheet is shared by several people. So if there are discrepancies or somebody might be able to accidentally change the, say for example, the approval or the status, 'di ba (right)? Just for contingency, we have that. Because again, it will affect the students' eligibility to enroll. So the weight of this is a bit serious.

[40:22] Student 1: Continuing, where do things tend to break down or cause delays?

[40:29] Ms. Nina: Right now? Pairings. (Laughter)

[40:34] Ms. Kelai: It's been a pain point even before. Whether we have portal, we have the Google Form, it's really the pairing.

[40:49] Ms. Nina: Because the schools will only be able to do the pairings once they have the enrolled students list, okay? And sometimes enrollment is extended, the enrollment period is extended, and then of course the schools are also involved in other academic activities during the start of the school year. So, you know, with the scheduling of classes, making sure that enough students are enrolled in a particular class...

[41:26] Student 1: Usually how long does the pairings take?

[41:33] Ms. Kelai: It depends per school. Kasi (Because) some of the schools, they have different coordinator for male and female. Pero (But) for some school, isang (only one) coordinator lang for both male and female.

[41:50] Ms. Nina: And it depends also on the volume of the students, okay? See, for example, for SMN, they have close to 400 students, as opposed to SSE that is less than 100. So just imagine how tedious it will... it can be for them.

[42:13] Student 1: I'm going to assume that the pairing process is manual din, 'no? (also, right?)

[42:17] Ms. Nina: Yes.

[42:19] Student 1: But on average, how long usually, on average?

[42:22] Ms. Nina: On average, give them say, for example, a week or two. Average 'yun, ha (That's average, okay), average. Because there are some na parang (that like) in like three days they were able to do it, 'di ba? Gano'n. Pero (Right? Like that. But) there are some that are...

[42:39] Ms. Kelai: Kasi may mga request, eh. May mga request, particular for particular "This individual I want this to be paired with this particular mentor only." And then may mga wishes din ang mga mentors, kaya medyo madugo talaga 'yung pairing. (Because there are requests. There are requests, particular for particular "This individual I want this to be paired with this particular mentor only." And then mentors also have wishes, that's why pairing is really quite bloody/tedious.)

[42:58] Ms. Nina: Siguro (Maybe) the matching is a challenge, talaga (really).

[43:03] Ms. Kelai: And then after pairing na parang okay na 'yung database mo, may isa, dalawa, tatlo na magche-change of mentor. Mas madugo 'yun, kasi you have to email the old mentor, email the new mentor, update your database, update the database of no'ng school, update the coordinators. (And then after pairing when it seems your database is already okay, there are one, two, three who will change mentor. That's more bloody/tedious, because you have to email the old

mentor, email the new mentor, update your database, update the database of the school, update the coordinators.)

[43:37] Student 1: I forgot my question, I was going to ask something... (Laughter)

[43:42] Ms. Nina: But what Miss Kelai said is actually true. So in one pairing alone, there's a lot of things going on. Hindi lang 'yung "Ah, itong batang 'to sige pwede na dito." Hindi siya gano'n. (It's not just "Ah, this kid okay can go here." It's not like that.)

[43:56] Ms. Kelai: Or A to B kay Mentor A, C to D kay Mentor B. Hindi rin, eh. (Or A to B to Mentor A, C to D to Mentor B. Not like that either.)

[44:03] Student 1: So the change of mentoring is that the student will first contact you, or...?

[44:10] Ms. Nina: Yes.

[44:11] Student 1: Contact you first, then email again to the mentor?

[44:14] Ms. Nina: Ah no, no. Once we received the request for the change of mentor, we evaluate the request, okay? Say for example, the old mentor has already resigned, or the old mentor is on sabbatical leave, so of course we would consider those as valid reasons for the immediate change of mentor. Okay? But there are also some requests that do not warrant an immediate change.

[44:47] Student 1: What are the reasons for the non-warranting of change?

[44:51] Ms. Nina: They haven't met their mentor! They just want another mentor, or they heard that this mentor is a good mentor, mga gano'n, 'di ba? (things like that, right?) So what we do is that we evaluate the request first. If we think that it is a valid request, that's when we facilitate the changing of mentor. But that would also require several steps. Like, as Miss Kelai said, you have to talk to the current mentor, you have to also talk to the proposed mentor or the new mentor if he or she can take on another mentee, and then you have to also check with the school. Maybe the school has paired that student with the current mentor because of a reason or another, and you have to respect that. So the student's request might not be granted or approved because of that particular reason. There are many things that come into play.

[46:02] Student 1: 'Yung (The) mentoring pairing, that happens usually at the, before or start or end of a semester?

[46:10] Ms. Nina: Start. We're actually checking if it's possible na (that) for the upperclassmen, we can start the pairing or the retaining of the mentors by the end of the school year. We're hoping that that's the ideal plan, okay? So that when we come in for the first semester, what happens is that we're just going to pair the new students.

[46:53] Student 1: With regards to the pairing delay, have you tried to fix it before, like to speed up the process?

[47:06] Ms. Nina: Have we tried? Yes. Has it been effective? No. (Laughter) Kasi it's the ano, eh (Because it's the what, you see), that's what... if you have a solution for us, because it's enrollment-dependent, eh (you see). 'Di ba (Right)? And the, what do you call this, engagement-dependent din ng (also of the) mentor. Why... how do I say this? There are some part-time faculty members who are also mentors and they haven't expressed their commitment to continue with their, what do you call this, with their service to the university as an employee, so you know, those are things that...

[48:06] Student 1: What kind of solutions have you tried before?

[48:10] Ms. Nina: We submitted the proposed list of mentors early on for approval. There were... there was significant delay, so that's why it was rather, what do you call this, it was rather difficult to pair the students without the official list of mentors first. Aside from that, we have also coordinated with the schools before the end of the school year, asking them if they're willing to retain the current pairings, 'di ba (right)? But there are some that would say to us na (that), "Ay wait, we'll check with you by the first semester."

[49:10] Ms. Kelai: Isa pang ginawa namin is the 'yung freshmen in JC, for us to see to it na they are all paired, Office of Student Mentoring 'yung nag-pair. It's the Office of Student Mentoring. And then we just give the the database or the paired to the to the respective schools. (Another thing we did is that the freshmen in JC, for us to see to it that they are all paired, it was the Office of Student Mentoring that paired them. It's the Office of Student Mentoring. And then we just give the database or the paired to the respective schools.)

[49:42] Ms. Nina: But you know, I just have to say this to you: because Mr. Pira knows the process very well, so this is a double-edged sword for you guys! (Laughter)

[49:56] Student 1: We will have to really... (Laughter)

[49:59] Ms. Nina: Because if you're going to tell him na ganito, alam niya kasi, eh. (that it's like this, he knows it, you see.) So ayun. (So there.) Alam niya 'yung process ng mentoring, eh. (He knows the process of mentoring, you see.)

[50:08] Student 1: We have to make it really good! (Laughter)

[50:12] Ms. Kelai: Kaya galingan niyo din. Basahin niyo 'yung policy para para hindi kayo mawala. (That's why do your best too. Read the policy so that you won't get lost.)

[50:18] Ms. Nina: 'Tsaka ano naman, kasi 'yung ginawa ni Mr. Pira, wala pang policy. So ngayon may policy, so it's fresh for you guys. So kung kunyari 'yung ginagawa namin na Google Form, you feel like there's another process that can improve it, the the flow, by all means, let us know. (And another thing, because what Mr. Pira made, there was no policy yet. So now there is a policy, so it's

fresh for you guys. So if for example what we are doing with Google Form, you feel like there's another process that can improve it, the flow, by all means, let us know.)

[50:41] Ms. Kelai: Because technically, medyo baby pa rin talaga ang Office of Student Mentoring. Kasi nga before, nakalahok siya sa with Guidance, as mentioned by Miss Nina. (Because technically, the Office of Student Mentoring is still quite a baby. Because before, it was merged with Guidance, as mentioned by Miss Nina.)

[50:53] Ms. Nina: And 'yun nga (that's it), what do you call this, this is the first time that it's going to be required. So how we go about this, you know...

[51:06] Ms. Kelai: First time din na it's the student. First time in history!

[51:15] Ms. Nina: So the students are now encouraged to reach out to their mentors because since it's a requirement, 'di ba (right)? (Laughter)

[51:28] Student 1: What would a success look like to you with this new policy?

[51:33] Ms. Nina: All students will have three sessions per semester! (Laughter) That's the success that we're aiming for!

[51:42] Ms. Kelai: And another siguro (maybe) success personally sa amin (for us) is 'pag tinanong ang isang estudyante about mentoring, made-define nila 'yun or mae-explain nila 'yon in their own words through their experience with their mentors, 'di ba? (when a student is asked about mentoring, they can define that or explain that in their own words through their experience with their mentors, right?)

[52:05] Ms. Nina: And corollary to what Miss Kelai said, I think students establishing good mentoring relationships with their mentors, 'di ba? That's the success na parang 'pag marinig namin na "Ah, I actually spoke with my mentor, this mentor helped me," mga gano'n. (That's the success where like when we hear that "Ah, I actually spoke with my mentor, this mentor helped me," things like that.)

[52:31] Ms. Kelai: And then probably, 'pag nakita niyo na 'yung 'yung value, 'yung essence ng mentoring, probably hindi na natin kailangan ng logging kasi talagang you yourself, kayo 'yung mag-i-initiate, 'di ba? Kasi makikita niyo na 'yung value ng mentoring sa journey niyo as a student, as future professional, and probably future mentor. (And then probably, when you see the value, the essence of mentoring, probably we won't even need logging because really you yourself, you will be the one to initiate, right? Because you will see the value of mentoring in your journey as a student, as future professional, and probably future mentor.)

[53:14] Student 1: Are there any other specific processes that you want us to focus on?

[53:23] Ms. Nina: 'Yun kasi talaga 'yung dalawang pain points, eh: pairing and monitoring. 'Yun ang pain points namin. (Those are really the two pain points: pairing and monitoring. Those are our pain points.) We're hoping that the system that we have, we're implementing for the recording, that the responsibility is with the students, it's going to help, it's going to address one issue. But for the pairing, if you have suggestions... (Laughter)

[53:51] Student 1: We will look into it.

[53:54] Ms. Nina: There are also some mentors that, you know, want to have a short profile of the mentees before they agree. May mga gano'n, ha? (There are cases like that, okay?) So, which we also respect din naman (as well), because you know, before you accept somebody as your... Because mentoring relationship is a serious matter, eh, 'di ba? (you see, right?) Since you have a mentoring relationship with Dr. Ladao, you'll understand what it entails from you, but it also entails a lot from the mentor, 'di ba? (right?) So it goes both ways, eh. So we also try to balance, you know, between the two.

[54:43] Ms. Kelai: And siguro kung medyo mag-a-ano pa tayo, medyo iaa-upgrade pa natin 'yung mga sarili natin, because of the data na magagamit natin, baka pwede rin nating magamit sa for example, training, possible training ng students, ng mentors, 'di ba? And then programs for the mentors, program for the mentoring program... (And maybe if we go a bit further, we upgrade ourselves a bit more, because of the data that we can use, maybe we can also use it for, for example, training, possible training of students, of mentors, right? And then programs for the mentors, program for the mentoring program...)

[55:11] Ms. Nina: I think what we want you to address, aside from the process, siguro (maybe) give us perspective or an idea coming from the perspective of a student: what you want the mentoring unit, what kind of service we can provide you. Because we've had before the Mentoring Space—were you aware of that before? No? Okay.

[55:46] Student 1: I'm fourth year.

[55:49] Ms. Nina: So yeah, we had the Mentoring Space, we had Mentoring Week, celebration...

[55:57] Student 1: Was that the one at the...? Okay. I'm aware of that.

[56:04] Ms. Nina: So we also want to expand the kind of programs that we will give to the students. That's another process in a sense, kasi (because) what we're talking about are mainly admin stuff, eh, 'di ba? (you see, right?) So aside from that, we also want, you know, something that will be addressed to the students talaga (really).

[56:31] Ms. Kelai: And then siguro para mapalawak din natin ang mentoring, like for example, there's peer mentoring, 'di ba? Pwede namin kayong i-train as a parang mga upper, oo, na kayo na

'yung magmememor do'n sa mga freshmen, 'di ba, why not, 'di ba? Na hindi lang limited sa mga mentors na staff and faculty. Why not kayo? Kayo mismo, you have your own language, eh, na makaka-relate din sila, 'di ba? It can also... We can also add the group mentoring, 'di ba? 'Yun 'yung mga wishes namin na medyo nakukuha nga 'yung time namin sa pairing pa lang, sa process pa lang, sa operations pa lang. (And then maybe to broaden mentoring, like for example, there's peer mentoring, right? We can train you as like upper [classmen], yes, that you will be the ones to mentor the freshmen, right, why not, right? That it's not just limited to mentors who are staff and faculty. Why not you? You yourselves, you have your own language, that they can also relate to, right? We can also add group mentoring, right? Those are our wishes, but our time is somewhat consumed just by the pairing alone, by the process alone, by operations alone.)

[57:29] Ms. Nina: But I think since conceptual 'yung ano sa inyo (the scope for you), you're focusing on operations talaga, eh (really). Yes, I understand. 'Yun lang naman 'yung mga bagay. (Those are just the things.) Right now kasi (because), we're in the same manner, we're focusing on the operations, and on the student-official mentor and mentee relationship.

[58:00] Student 1: Is there a deadline for the pairing and the...?

[58:05] Ms. Nina: We've set it. Dapat (It should be) by next week, complete na (already). Right now kasi, ano na lang naman (because, it's just), konti na lang (a few left). Konting-konti na lang (Very few left).

[58:18] Student 1: Is there any consequence of not meeting this deadline for the pairing?

[58:24] Ms. Nina: Well, the students are supposed to have their first mentoring session within this month. Ideally, yeah. Although if they won't be able to meet within this month naman (anyway), they are just required to complete it within the semester. Because we understand rin naman (also anyway) that there might be circumstances that might prevent them from meeting their mentors. Minsan kasi, even if you set a schedule, minsan may biglang 'di nagkakatugma, minsan naman dahil sa dami ng suspensions for the past few weeks, 'di ba? (Sometimes because, even if you set a schedule, sometimes things suddenly don't align, sometimes because of the many suspensions for the past few weeks, right?)

[59:16] Student 1: What matters to you most on how student data is handled?

[59:25] Ms. Nina: What matters to us most? That it is correct! Correct! Kasi 'yun 'yung nagiging problema, eh (Because that's what becomes the problem). Correct and consistent across the different data processors. Okay? What do I mean by that? Say for example, the data that we have kung sino ang mentor nitong student na 'to (on who the mentor of this student is), it should be the same as what the school has. Okay? So that correct 'yung sa 'min, correct 'yung sa kanila,

consistent siya. (correct on our end, correct on their end, it is consistent.) Kasi hindi lang kami 'yung nagpa-process ng data, 'yung schools din. (Because we aren't the only ones processing data, the schools do too.)

[60:06] Ms. Kelai: 'Tsaka (And) probably what matters to us is 'yung data is masasagot 'yung mga katanungan din ng ManCom. Kung ano 'yung tanong ng ManCom, sana ma-provide ng data. And 'yun nga, 'yung mga simple, sabi nga ni Miss Nina, consistency. For example, ang naka-declare na met is this one, halimbawa 50, ang unmet is 45, pero ang total number of enrolled students ng SSE is 100, so nasaan 'yung lima? 'Yung mga gano'n. (the data will answer the questions of the ManCom. Whatever the questions of ManCom are, hopefully the data can provide it. And that's it, the simple, as Miss Nina said, consistency. For example, what is declared as met is this one, for example 50, unmet is 45, but the total number of enrolled students of SSE is 100, so where are the five? Things like that.)

[60:51] Student 1: Are there any other university policies or data privacy rules or compliance requirements we should be aware of when handling the mentee-mentor information?

[61:05] Ms. Nina: The mentoring assignment is confidential. Okay? So unless you disclose it to us—you did—it's not required of you to disclose to other people who your mentor is. In the same manner, the mentors are, you know, they should observe confidentiality when it comes to who their mentees are and what is discussed during... But for you guys, I'm not giving you any information naman, eh. Hindi ko naman sinasabi kung sino-sino 'yung mga students at kung sino-sino 'yung mentors. (I'm not telling you who the students are and who the mentors are.) So I don't think that there's an issue. It's just that, yeah, the program itself is, as Miss Kelai said, new to an extent. It's still in the infant stage. Okay? The program with the new policy is actually very new! (Laughter) So check back with us by the end of the semester!

[62:34] Ms. Nina: The data privacy, siguro 'yung (maybe the) reasons as to how we approve the change of mentors, you know? 'Di ba, I mentioned to you, kasi kailangan mong malaman 'yon, personal. Yeah, and then the pairings din, the preferences when it comes to pairings, that's something that I hope you don't disclose. (Right, I mentioned to you, because you need to know that, it's personal. Yeah, and then the pairings too, the preferences when it comes to pairings, that's something that I hope you don't disclose.)

[63:01] Ms. Kelai: Especially 'yung change of mentor. Sino 'yung mentor ang chinange, sino 'yung dating mentor... (Especially the change of mentor. Who was the mentor changed, who was the previous mentor...)

[63:13] Ms. Nina: 'Yung process lang naman sinabi namin sa inyo, eh. Hindi naman namin sinabi 'yung mga tao. Pero of course, how we go about the process itself, it's confidential. (It was only the process that we told you. We didn't tell you the people. But of course, how we go about the process itself, it's confidential.)

[63:28] Student 1: How comfortable are you guys with adopting new tools or changing the process, even if it's a new policy?

[63:39] Ms. Nina: How comfortable are we? So comfortable! If you have any suggestions, you know, anything that you think would make our lives easier... I'm actually happy nga, eh, kasi (really, because) you confirmed with me today that I can, you know, connect the two forms! So it will make my life easier, so I just have to research on it, 'di ba? (right?) (Laughter)

[64:06] Student 1: If we're, let's say, that we're going to introduce a new tool or system or process, how long will the approval phase take?

[64:17] Ms. Nina: CSA level, give us at most two weeks. CSA level. ManCom level... (Laughter) But you know, they might be open to suggestions, you know, because the policy is new. So we're given a free hand on how to implement it. So if what you will propose is going to be far more, far much better, easier for us, they might... We might be able to get approval. I just don't know the timeline because it depends on a lot of things.

[65:08] Ms. Kelai: And probably, for example, 'yung mga pilot sessions natin, for example, SSE lang. Hindi natin papakialaman 'yung ibang schools. Probably medyo mas madali kung SSE lang ang guguluhin natin: SSE data, SSE list ng students... Ilan ba ang SSE? (And probably, for example, our pilot sessions, for example, SSE only. We won't touch the other schools. Probably it's a bit easier if we only deal with SSE: SSE data, SSE list of students... How many are in SSE?)

[65:34] Student 1: Siguro (Maybe) about 100 at most.

[65:36] Ms. Kelai: 'Di ba? (Right?)

[65:43] Student 1: Realistically, who would need to be trained or onboarded if we were to change something?

[65:49] Ms. Nina: The two of us. Yeah, just the two of us. Kasi (Because) if ever that there will... Right now kasi, wala namang involvement ang coordinators do'n sa mga database namin, eh. (Right now, the coordinators don't have any involvement in our databases.)

[66:10] Ms. Nina: No'ng una nga, ang gusto namin was... I'll share ko lang. No'ng una, gusto namin do'n sa Google Sheet for the log form, ideally ha, ma-view ng mga coordinators. Kaso lang, ang gusto lang naming makita nila kung sino-sino 'yung students within their schools. So medyo mahirap daw 'yon. Sabi ko, "Ah sige, kami na lang magbibigay ng summary sa kanila." We're the

ones who is going to filter the data. If we can automate that, even better, 'di ba? (At first, what we wanted was... I'll just share. At first, we wanted that in the Google Sheet for the log form, ideally, the coordinators can view it. However, we only wanted them to see who the students are within their schools. So [IT said] that was somewhat difficult. I said, "Ah okay, we'll just be the ones to give them the summary." We're the ones who is going to filter the data. If we can automate that, even better, right?)

[66:46] Student 1: So far, there's nothing that's completely off the table?

[66:52] Ms. Nina: How do you mean?

[66:53] Student 1: Like any specific tool or system that we propose is okay with you? Everything's okay?

[67:05] Ms. Nina: Everything is open. We're open to things. Okay. If you're going to propose this kind of thing, as long as it follows the policy, because that's our main role, eh: policy implementer kami, eh. (you see: we are policy implementers.)

[67:35] Student 1: I think that's it.

[67:36] Ms. Kelai: Ang daming notes! Nakaka-pressure! (Laughter) Ang daming notes, nakakahiya! (So many notes! It's pressuring! So many notes, it's embarrassing!)

[67:41] Student 1: We have a lot of notes because we learned from our Introduction to IT Research when we were meeting with our client for our capstone project.

[67:52] Student 2: Madami talaga 'yung kailangan naming alamin: 'yung process, 'yung data na kinukuha nila... (There's really a lot we need to know: the process, the data they gather...)

[68:00] Ms. Kelai: And medyo na-train naman kami diyan because nag-ano kami kay Doc Stella... ah, Doc PA. (And we were somewhat trained there because we did with Doc Stella... ah, Doc PA.)

[68:18] Student 2: Tapos ang hirap din kasi talaga na may ma-miss kami, kasi it will cost us time din. (And it's also really difficult if we miss something, because it will also cost us time.)

[68:24] Student 1: It will cost us greatly in the future.

[68:27] Ms. Nina: But if you have questions, say for example after this interview if you have questions, just send us an email. Okay? Or you can drop by. If we're free, we can talk to you naman (anyway). Kailan ba deadline niyan? (When is the deadline for that?)

[68:41] Student 1: At least for the first draft of the proposal, it's this Tuesday.

[68:44] Ms. Nina: Oh my gosh! I'm so sorry! Kaya niyo 'yan! (You can do that!) (Laughter)

[68:50] Ms. Kelai: Gawa na kayo ng Google group chat. (Make a Google group chat already.)

[68:55] Student 1: Google group chat? Sure.

[68:57] Ms. Nina: So that you can, if you have questions, we can answer you guys.

[69:04] Student 2: For the group chat, I think we need your emails po to add.

[69:14] Ms. Nina: You can use the invitation [calendar invite].

[69:18] Student 2: Ah, okay, yeah.

[69:33] Student 1: Thank you po, Miss. (Thank you, ma'am.) I think that's all of the questions we need to ask. And we learned a lot about your processes din (also). And I think we're starting to have a good idea of what we can offer you.

[70:00] Ms. Kelai: May idea na kayo? (Do you have an idea already?)

[70:03] Student 1: Somewhat.

[70:07] Student 1: Thank you for your time and helping us as well.

[70:10] Ms. Nina: You're welcome. So Emmanuel Velasco, DeeJay Clark Datu, right? Okay.